

You were right — it had gone red

And the reason is measurable. **Maroon isn't a hue — it's a red with the vividness held down.** I turned vividness up from 37 to 56 and left the hue where it was, which by definition stops being maroon. Here's the fix, and the number that controls it.

01 — Diagnosis

One number: the blue lean

#732438

Your original **BEFORE**

lightness 27.3
vividness 36.9
blue lean +6.5

Correct as maroon, but dark and a little flat — which is what you asked me to fix.

#A31D4A

My last attempt

READS RED

lightness 36.3
vividness 55.8
blue lean +8.7

I pushed vividness hard and let the lean drift further toward orange. That is a crimson.

#8E2653

Corrected **WINE**

lightness 33.5
vividness 47.0
blue lean -1.7

Lighter and richer than your original, but tipped toward purple — so it stays wine.

The lever is the blue lean, not the vividness. A positive number tips a red toward orange; a negative one tips it toward purple. Your original sat at +6.5, my crimson at +8.7 — both leaning orange, which is the direction of tomato red. The corrected wine sits at -1.7, on the purple side of pure red.

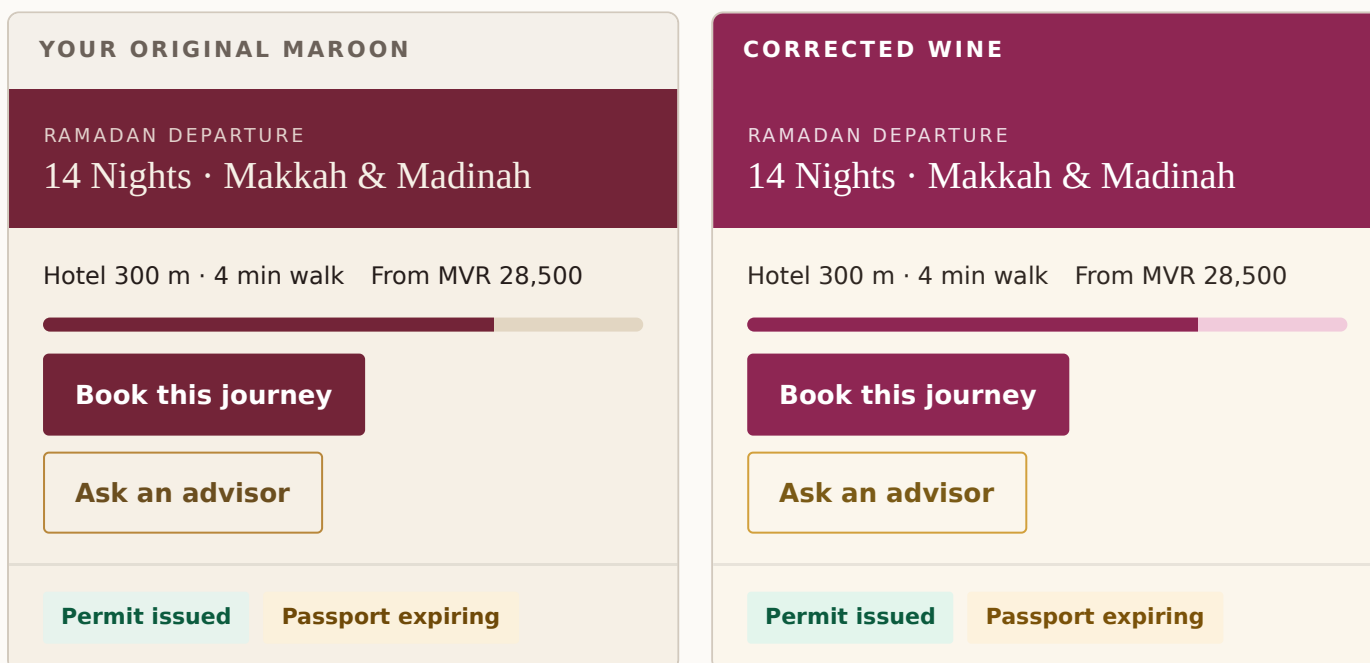
That's why it still reads as maroon at a vividness of 47, where the crimson stopped reading as maroon at 56. **You get most of the brightness back and keep the character.**

Final four



- **Wine #8E2653** — six points lighter and ten points more vivid than your original, leaning purple instead of orange. White text sits at 8.2:1.
- **Gold #D2A03C** — unchanged from the brighter set. It was never the problem, and a warm gold is what lifts the wine.
- **Ink #2E2621** and **Cream #FBF6EC** — also unchanged. Softer than near-black, airier than beige.

Original and corrected



All three, on the dhoni



original



too red



corrected

05 – Wine ramp

The full range

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900
#FCF5F8	#F9E7EF	#F1CBDB	#E7A6C3	#DA76A2	#8E2653	#731F43	#5B1835	#441228	#300D1C

06 – Verified

Everything checks out

COLOUR	HEX	WHITE TEXT	NOTE
Wine (brand & buttons)	#8E2653	8.23	Comfortable
Gold (accent only)	#D2A03C	2.38	Never a button — with dark ink it's 6.2:1
Success	#0F7A54	5.34	Can't be brightened and stay legible
Warning	#9E6A0D	4.64	Passes
Error	#D92D20	4.83	Passes
Ink (body text)	#2E2621	14.84	On cream, 13.8:1

- **The error-red problem went away with it.** Separation from #D92D20 is back to ΔE 56 — marginally better than your original maroon managed, and well clear of the crimson's 44.
- **Green is still the one I can't brighten.** Every livelier green fails white text, so solid fills stay at #0F7A54 and the status chips use a pale background with dark green text instead.

07 – Tokens

Ready for the config

```
// tailwind.config.js – theme.extend.colors
wine: {
  50: '#FCF5F8', 100: '#F9E7EF', 200: '#F1CBDB', 300: '#E7A6C3', 400: '#DA76A2',
  500: '#8E2653', 600: '#731F43', 700: '#5B1835', 800: '#441228', 900: '#300D1C',
},
gold: { 400: '#E8C270', 500: '#D2A03C', 600: '#A87F2C', 700: '#7A5A16' },
ink: { DEFAULT: '#2E2621', muted: '#6B6159' },
cream: { DEFAULT: '#FBF6EC', deep: '#F4EDDF' },

// semantic – never decorative
success: '#0F7A54', warning: '#9E6A0D', error: '#D92D20',
```

Lightness (L*), vividness (C*) and blue lean (b*) measured in CIE L*a*b* / L*C*h. Contrast ratios computed to the WCAG 2.2 relative-luminance formula against #FFFFFF. Separations (ΔE) computed in CIE L*a*b*.